

BRIAN JARRETT

Senior Systems/Platform Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Systems & Platform Engineer with a 30-year foundation beginning in U.S. Air Force avionics, specializing in rigorous system validation, infrastructure automation, and data integrity. Proven track record of mastering complex, unfamiliar architectures and becoming an organizational SME. Architect of robust ETL pipelines (Python/SQL) that enforce data quality at the source to deliver authoritative sources of truth. An objective, fact-based troubleshooter who translates intricate system, storage, and networking data into resilient operational workflows that fix the core infrastructure issues hindering operations teams and executives.

SKILLS

Data & Systems Engineering:

- Python (Pandas, NumPy, Flask, SQLAlchemy)
- ETL Pipeline & Data Validation
- PostgreSQL, MySQL, MSSQL
- Validation and QA Testing
- Systems/Robotics Design

Systems & Distributed Scale:

- Cisco UCS & Fabric Interconnect
- OpenStack (Nova, Heat)
- vSphere/ESXi, XenServer, Proxmox/ KVM
- Ceph Block Storage (RBD)
- High-Availability (HA) Clustering

DevOps, Security & Leadership:

- Ansible, SaltStack
- CI/CD (GitHub Actions, Jenkins)
- FreeIPA/LDAP, RBAC/HBAC
- FedRAMP Compliance, Qualys
- Monitoring, Diagnostics, Troubleshooting
- Technical Leadership & Mentoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cisco Systems | Cloud Engineering Technical Leader

Aug 2019 - July 2026 (Remote) * Infrastructure & Operations Lead: Led operations of critical compute and storage systems on **Cisco UCS** hardware for the Webex for Government (FedRAMP) cloud, maintaining high platform availability and strict SLA tracking. *** Data Platform Engineering:** Designed, deployed, and operated a vulnerability management system using a custom ETL pipeline to extract data from **Jira API** and synchronize it to a **PostgreSQL** database. Built a **Python (Pandas, SQLAlchemy)** web frontend and connected **Tableau** dashboards to display executive-level SLA metrics and real-time remediation progress. *** Compliance Automation:** Engineered Python reporting tools to parse raw **STIG XCCDF (XML)** files and merge them with security data using the **Qualys API**, generating automated, audit-ready compliance checklists. *** Technical Mentorship:** Provided technical guidance across federal cloud environments, mentoring multi-tier engineering teams in analysis and troubleshooting of complex compliance and system performance issues. *** Skills:** Python (Pandas, SQLAlchemy), PostgreSQL, REST APIs (Jira, Qualys), ETL Pipelines, Tableau, Ansible, RHEL/Ubuntu, Cisco UCS, STIG/FedRAMP Compliance.

Cisco Systems | Cloud Systems Engineer

Jan 2017 - Aug 2019 (Remote) * Identity & Access Management: Designed and deployed a **High-Availability (HA) FreeIPA cluster** using **Ansible** to implement RBAC/HBAC across **2,000+ servers, storage nodes, and network devices**, replacing an aging 389-ds directory framework. *** Virtualization & Security:** Administered large-scale compute environments using **vSphere** on **Cisco UCS** hardware. Orchestrated **Qualys** vulnerability scanning and patch remediation across commercial and FedRAMP sites while maintaining core bastion and identity services. *** Skills:** Ansible, FreeIPA, OpenStack, VMware vSphere, Cisco UCS, RHEL/CentOS, Windows Server, RBAC/HBAC, Qualys, FedRAMP Compliance.

Select Group @ Cisco | Cloud DevOps/QA Engineer (Contract)

Feb 2016 - Jan 2017 (Remote) * Performance Optimization: Identified and removed redundant **Nova Scheduler** filters in **OpenStack**, reducing instance scheduling time for 700 nodes from 20 seconds to 5 seconds (a **75% improvement** in orchestration speed). *** Cloud Infrastructure:** Configured and evaluated **RHUI (Red Hat Update Infrastructure)** and **Proxmox** clusters for InterCloud Services. Automated bare-metal server configuration using **Ansible** via lights-out management (LOM) interfaces. Troubleshot and resolved a critical

OpenStack **cloudbase-init** race condition on Windows images that was causing constant reboots. * **Cloud QA:** Managed global test cycles for Compute and Heat components during cloud upgrades. Developed **Python, Bash,** and **Ansible** scripts to perform comprehensive automated orchestration tests. * **Skills:** OpenStack, Ansible, Python, Bash, RHUI, Proxmox, CentOS/RHEL/Windows, Performance Tuning, Cloud QA.

Australian Laboratory Services | Senior Systems & Storage Administrator

Sep 2014 - Jan 2016 (Grand Junction, CO) * Distributed Storage & Virtualization: Engineered an Ubuntu-based **Ceph cluster** for **VMware ESXi** hosts, benchmarking iSCSI vs. RBD performance. Used **Ceph RBD snapshots** for automated schema migration testing with zero errors. * **Data Integrity & Automation:** Wrote custom **Python (SQLAlchemy)** verification scripts to audit SQL foreign keys during data migration. Implemented **SaltStack** to automate Linux VM and Ceph node provisioning. * **System Monitoring & Network Hardware:** Integrated **Nagios** and **Observium** to monitor network operations, reducing service restarts. Diagnosed WAN/VPN bottlenecks and upgraded gateway hardware to double network throughput. * **Skills:** Ubuntu, Ceph RBD, VMware ESXi, SaltStack, Python, SQLAlchemy, Nagios, Observium, MySQL, Asterisk, VPN Routing.

Garfield County School District 16 | Senior Systems/Network Administrator

Oct 2002 - Jun 2014 (Parachute, CO) * Systems Integration & Automation: Programmed a custom **Flask (SQLAlchemy)** app syncing Student Info Systems with **Active Directory** and **Google Apps**, reducing account helpdesk tickets by **97%**. * **Network & VoIP Engineering:** Designed a high-speed WAN using **Ruckus wireless bridges**, increasing bandwidth by **6,500%** (1.5Mbps to 100+ Mbps) with zero monthly service costs. Deployed district-wide Cisco CallManager. * **Compute Modernization:** Centralized desktop computing with **Windows Terminal Servers** and **HP Thin Clients** for 6 labs, saving **\$60k+** in CAPEX. Replaced legacy databases with centralized PostgreSQL platforms, and automated state compliance reporting via custom PHP scripts. * **Skills:** Python, Flask, SQLAlchemy, PHP, PostgreSQL, XenServer, VirtualBox, Cisco Routers/Switches/PIX, Cisco CallManager, Ruckus Wireless.

Foundational Experience

1991 - 2002 * Solutions Engineer/Software QA Lead (StorageSoft/Phoenix Tech): Gathered requirements, deployed software, and provided training for customers. Managed testing and support departments. Structured QA testing workflows for **ImageCast** disk cloning tools and designed Windows/Linux/Networking test lab environments. * **Airborne Radar Journeyman (U.S. Air Force):** Repaired high-power microwave systems, high-voltage circuits, and analog/digital systems on AWACS aircraft. * **Skills:** Analog & Digital Diagnostics, PC Architecture, Disk Cloning (ImageCast), Software QA, Network Design, Technical Training.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Linux Academy/A Cloud Guru** AWS/Red Hat courses
- **Regis University** C Programming/Unix courses
- **Lincoln Christian University** Music Theory and Composition
- **Community College of the Air Force:** Avionics/Electronics Technician - RADAR Specialist (AWACS)
- **On the Job/Field Training - Tinker AFB, OK** AWACS RADAR and IFF systems Journeyman - Awarded Senior Airman Below-the-Zone
- **Air Force Technical Training School - Keesler AFB, MS** Electronics and AWACS RADAR Courses - Honor Graduate (99% Test Average)
- **Colorado School of Mines:** 2 Years - Electrical Engineering/Physics

For a list of legacy certifications, see [linkedin.com/in/bjarrett/details/certifications/](https://www.linkedin.com/in/bjarrett/details/certifications/)